

SAHEL ZAFFARULLA

IT Lead — Infrastructure, Cloud & Multi-Site Operations

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Portfolio: sahelzaffar-portfolio.netlify.app

SUMMARY

IT Lead heading end-to-end IT operations for an international shipping group across **India, the UAE, Oman, and Malaysia** — advancing from technical support to sole-charge IT ownership within two years of entering the industry. Independently manage infrastructure, Microsoft 365 and cloud, networking and security, telephony, automation, procurement, and vendor negotiations across multiple office locations, combining boardroom-level decision-making with hands-on, on-site execution. Known for building office IT environments from the ground up, delivering zero-downtime migrations, and running operations with a structured, checklist-driven discipline.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Multi-country IT leadership & operations
- Microsoft 365 & Azure cloud administration
- Identity, access & endpoint management
- Enterprise networking, firewalls & VPN
- IP telephony & unified communications
- Vendor management, negotiation & procurement
- Automation & scripting (PowerShell)
- IT service management & asset lifecycle
- Email infrastructure, DNS & domain security
- Office IT build-outs & migrations

WORK EXPERIENCE

IT Lead | IGM Shipping Pvt. Ltd. (Interglobe Marine), Mumbai

Apr 2026 – Present

Sole IT authority for an international shipping group — own all IT operations across multiple offices in India, Dubai (UAE), Oman, and Malaysia, reporting directly to the Managing Director.

- Lead **end-to-end IT operations across four countries** — infrastructure, networking, security, cloud, telephony, and end-user computing — as the organization's single point of IT ownership, including regular on-site deployments.
- **Modernized and secured the corporate email infrastructure** — domain security and authentication records, DNS management, and advanced threat-protection policies across the organization.
- Designing and rolling out a **centralized multi-site IP telephony platform** connecting offices over secure site-to-site links, owning the solution from design and vendor selection through procurement and deployment.
- **Negotiated enterprise internet and connectivity contracts** with service providers across regions, driving multiple negotiation rounds to significantly reduced annual commercials.
- Planned and delivered **complete IT setups for new international offices** in the Middle East and Southeast Asia — connectivity, networking, endpoints, and local vendor coordination.
- Deployed **secure remote-access and inter-branch connectivity solutions** for the distributed workforce, and resolved complex cross-site networking issues.
- Implementing a **company-wide IT service management and asset tracking platform**, including automated agent rollout across all locations.
- Built **automation for employee onboarding and device provisioning**, standardizing IT rollout across branches.
- Own **all vendor relationships, AMCs, and hardware procurement** — including a corporate laptop fleet refresh — along with the company domain portfolio and IT budget recommendations to leadership.

Systems Engineer | Medpace Clinical Research Organization Pvt. Ltd., Navi Mumbai

Aug 2025 – Apr 2026

Enterprise-scale exposure in a global, regulated clinical-research environment — recruited into a lead-level, single-owner IT role at IGM after 8 months.

- Managed enterprise **identity and endpoint operations** across Active Directory, Entra ID, Microsoft Intune, and Windows Autopilot, including custom device-management policies aligned to organizational security standards.
- Administered **enterprise-wide patching and software deployment**, and authored PowerShell scripts to automate endpoint and administrative tasks.
- Diagnosed and resolved **complex enterprise incidents** affecting users organization-wide, earning a reputation for root-cause analysis on issues others couldn't isolate.
- Collaborated with **European core-infrastructure teams** on a global IT support telephony platform transition.

IT Executive (Sole IT Charge) | Goodrich Logistics, Mumbai

Jun 2024 – Aug 2025

First single-owner IT role — managed complete IT operations for HQ and branch offices within two years of entering the industry.

- Led **migration of 400+ mailboxes and 2TB+ of data** from on-premises mail servers to Microsoft 365 with zero significant downtime, including full DNS and mail-security configuration and post-migration stabilization.
- Designed and implemented **enterprise identity services** — directory design, user and group management, policy administration, and access control.
- Planned **office IT setups from scratch** and deployed enterprise network infrastructure with secure site-to-site connectivity between HQ and branches.
- Implemented **enterprise firewall and endpoint security** — security policies, hardening, monitoring, and incident response.
- Deployed a **cloud-hosted telephony platform on Microsoft Azure** with a high-availability, fault-tolerant architecture and secure networking.

Technical Support Engineer | High Tech Birds, Mumbai Mar 2023 - Feb 2024

- Provided enterprise technical support — directory account operations, hardware lifecycle, and end-user systems — while completing a full-time IT degree; built the foundation for rapid advancement into infrastructure ownership roles.

KEY PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Zero-downtime cloud mail migration:** 400+ users and 2TB+ of mailbox data moved to Microsoft 365 with no data loss and seamless user transition.
- **International office IT build-outs:** ground-up IT planning and delivery for new offices across the Middle East, Southeast Asia, and India — from connectivity and networking to endpoints and vendors.
- **Enterprise IT asset management system:** asset tracking solution delivering ~40% reduction in manual tracking effort and 95% improvement in asset visibility.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science — Information Technology | Amity University, Mumbai · CGPA 7.8/10 2021 - 2024

Completed alongside full-time IT roles — balancing academics with professional growth from the first year of the degree.

Senior Secondary (CBSE) | St. Wilfred School, Mumbai · 73% 2019 - 2021

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AZ-900** — Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals
 - **AZ-104** — Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate
 - **AZ-204** — Microsoft Certified: Azure Developer Associate
- **AZ-305** — Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert
 - **MS-102** — Microsoft 365 Certified: Administrator Expert
 - **Google IT Support & Automation** — Google (Coursera)

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

Technical leadership & single-owner accountability · Vendor negotiation & cost optimization · Stakeholder & MD-level communication · Cross-cultural coordination across India, the Middle East & Southeast Asia · Checklist & process-driven execution · Calm, structured decision-making under pressure

LANGUAGES & INTERESTS

- **Languages:** English (professional working proficiency) · Hindi (native) · Marathi (conversational)
- **Interests:** Aviation — structured study of aircraft systems, navigation, and meteorology · Cricket (active player and analytics enthusiast) · Fitness and disciplined training · Exploring new technology and automation tools